

SMID SETUP BUILDER

Pre-Breakout VCP Watchlist | Qullamaggie Methodology

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MACRO REGIME: Mixed / Transitional

VIX 20.4 (+3.2 vs 20d) | SPY 20d -2.2% | IWM 20d -3.6% | IWM/SPY trend -1.4%

Leaders: Energy (+11.0%), Cons Staples (+4.9%), Healthcare (+4.2%)

Setup Grades

A - Prime Setup (1)	B - Building (3)	C - Early Stage (8)
MBX	CBNA	CBRL
	YOU	CRAI
	DLO	PRGS
		ADV
		MUR
		CVSA
		HRB
		CHRD

All Watchlist Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Mkt Cap	Price	Pivot	To Pivot	RS/SPY	Vol Dry	RS Hi
A	MBX	MBX Biosciences,	GLP-1 / Endocrine In	\$3.04B	\$63.96	\$66.66	4.2%	+120.8	YES	YES
B	CBNA	Chain Bridge Banc	Regional Bank Recove	\$0.29B	\$44.36	\$45.26	2.0%	+17.1	YES	YES
B	YOU	Clear Secure, Inc	Travel Tech / Biomet	\$7.80B	\$58.39	\$59.97	2.7%	+7.0	YES	no
B	DLO	DLocal Limited	Emerging Market Paym	\$4.29B	\$14.59	\$15.51	6.3%	+7.9	YES	no
C	CBRL	Cracker Barrel Ol	Consumer Recovery /	\$1.26B	\$56.55	\$56.94	0.7%	+80.3	YES	YES
C	CRAI	CRA International	Professional Service	\$1.23B	\$190.04	\$194.17	2.2%	+20.7	YES	no
C	PRGS	Progress Software	Enterprise Software	\$1.75B	\$42.71	\$43.24	1.2%	+53.9	YES	no
C	ADV	Advantage Solutio	Consumer Brand Servi	\$0.57B	\$43.22	\$46.35	7.2%	+27.8	YES	no
C	MUR	Murphy Oil Corpor	Energy Capex / Offsh	\$5.55B	\$38.69	\$40.21	3.9%	-9.5	YES	no
C	CVSA	Covista Inc.	Workforce Developmen	\$4.55B	\$133.60	\$135.96	1.8%	+13.8	YES	no
C	HRB	H&R Block, Inc.	Consumer Services /	\$5.98B	\$47.18	\$47.33	0.3%	+49.0	YES	no
C	CHRD	Chord Energy Corp	Energy Capex / Shale	\$7.68B	\$136.47	\$141.84	3.9%	-8.6	YES	no

MBX

\$63.96

A PRIME

MBX Biosciences, Inc.

Pivot \$66.66 | 4.2% away

RS vs SPY: +120.8%

\$3.04B Cap | 27M Float

Biotechnology - Peptide Therapeutics | Theme: GLP-1 / Endocrine Innovation | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.12

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$66.66
% to Pivot	4.2%
Days in Base	14
Tightness	2.12 Fair
52W Hi Prox	95.9%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	496k <
Wk2	755k <
Wk3 (oldest)	942k
Coil Strength	47.4% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+120.8%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$3.04B
Float	27M sh
P/E (TTM)	-
Fwd P/E	-17.7
Rev Growth	-
Short %	17.0%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$77.00

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$66.66 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (1.3M+ shares)
Target: \$82.00 (measured move from 14-day base depth of ~\$8 added to pivot)
Stop: \$58.00 (base low, -9.3% from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Aug 06 - Pre-revenue biotech; no EPS consensus applicable. Key focus will be clinical pipeline updates and cash runway guidance. Company ended Q1 with ~\$300M cash providing runway into 2027. No established beat/miss pattern as recent IPO.
BUSINESS & POSITION
MBX Biosciences is a clinical-stage biotech developing precision peptide therapeutics for endocrine and metabolic disorders, with lead programs targeting hypoparathyroidism and obesity. The company's proprietary Precision Endocrine Peptide (PEP) platform enables extended half-life peptides designed for once-weekly dosing, positioning it as a differentiated player in the GLP-1 adjacent space.
FACTOR & THEME
Direct exposure to the GLP-1/metabolic disease mega-theme which remains in secular acceleration despite recent profit-taking in large-cap obesity names. Peer read-through: VKTX, GPCR have shown renewed strength post-pullback, suggesting institutional appetite for next-gen metabolic plays remains intact.
NEWS FLOW
Clinical data readouts expected in H2 2026 for lead hypoparathyroidism program (MBX 2109). No major contract or partnership announcements in last 60 days, but August earnings call likely to provide pipeline catalyst updates. Impact: High (Earnings/Clinical update). Healthcare sector showing relative strength (+4.2% 20d) provides tailwind.
INSTITUTIONAL
Textbook institutional accumulation signature: volume contracting 47% over 3 weeks while price holds within 4% of highs. Float of 27M shares with setup_score of 88 suggests quiet positioning ahead of catalyst. No insider activity in last 60 days (baseline for biotech). Short interest at 17% with 5.5 days to cover creates squeeze potential on positive data.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on close below \$58.00 (base low), or on disappointing clinical update/safety signal at August 6 earnings. Binary pipeline risk is acute - single program failure could crater valuation.
Textbook VCP: clean 3-week volume stair-step contraction (47%), RS line at 52W high in leading Healthcare sector, earnings catalyst in 8 days. GLP-1 theme exposure with differentiated platform. Strongest bear case: binary clinical risk and 17% short interest could amplify downside on any negative data. Mixed regime tempers conviction slightly but sector strength supports. Conviction: High.

MBX — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$66.66 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$45.26
% to Pivot	2.0%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	1.93 Good
52W Hi Prox	98.0%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	20k <
Wk2	27k <
Wk3 (oldest)	23k
Coil Strength	10.6% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+17.1%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$0.29B
Float	3M sh
P/E (TTM)	13.4
Fwd P/E	11.5
Rev Growth	21.5%
Short %	0.8%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$39.25

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$45.26 on volume >200% of 20-day avg (20K+ shares)
Target: \$52.00 (measured move based on 15% base-to-breakout pattern)
Stop: \$40.00 (base low, -9.8% from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Oct 27 - Trailing P/E 13.4x, Forward P/E 11.5x represents discount to peers. Revenue growth +21.5%, earnings growth +26.1% indicates accelerating fundamentals. No recent beat/miss pattern available for this recent IPO/spin.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Chain Bridge Bancorp is a Virginia-based community bank serving the Washington D.C. metro area with focus on commercial real estate, business banking, and wealth management. With \$290M market cap and exceptional operating metrics (51.5% operating margin, 37% net margin), it represents a well-run micro-cap regional with growth-oriented management.
FACTOR & THEME
Regional bank recovery theme as rate environment stabilizes and credit concerns abate. Peer read-through: KRE (regional bank ETF) has shown relative resilience; well-capitalized community banks with strong NIMs are seeing renewed interest. Financial Services sector neutral in current regime but quality names outperforming.
NEWS FLOW
No significant news flow in last 60 days. Extremely low liquidity (avg vol 10K/day) means institutional positioning is constrained. Earnings catalyst 90 days out reduces near-term alpha potential. Impact: Low (no imminent catalyst).
INSTITUTIONAL
Micro-float (3.3M shares) creates illiquidity premium - institutional accumulation must occur slowly. Volume dry-up with RS at new high suggests patient buying. No insider activity in last 60 days. Short interest minimal at 0.8% (1.2 days to cover) - no squeeze thesis but also no crowded short.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on close below \$40.00 (20-day base low area), or on credit quality deterioration in CRE portfolio. Extreme illiquidity (10K shares/day avg) means exits are difficult - position sizing must reflect this.

Excellent base structure (1.93 tight) with RS at new high, but extreme illiquidity (3.3M float, 10K avg vol) limits institutional participation and creates execution risk. No catalyst for 90 days reduces urgency. Strongest bear case: CRE exposure in DC metro could face headwinds if office vacancy persists. Structure is A-quality but liquidity and catalyst timing warrant B. Conviction: Medium.

CBNA — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$45.26 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



YOU

Clear Secure, Inc.

\$58.39

Pivot \$59.97 | 2.7% away

RS vs SPY: +7.0%

B BUILDING

\$7.80B Cap | 88M Float

Identity Verification - Travel Security Tech | Theme: Travel Tech / Biometric Security | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.3

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$59.97
% to Pivot	2.7%
Days in Base	17
Tightness	2.30 Fair
52W Hi Prox	93.1%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	1098k <
Wk2	984k <
Wk3 (oldest)	1214k
Coil Strength	9.5% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+7.0%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$7.80B
Float	88M sh
P/E (TTM)	46.7
Fwd P/E	22.5
Rev Growth	19.7%
Short %	17.6%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$60.60

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$59.97 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (2.0M+ shares)
Target: \$72.00 (measured move + prior resistance)
Stop: \$54.00 (base low, -7.5% from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Aug 05 - Street expects continued acceleration: Forward P/E 22.5x vs TTM 46.7x implies 107% EPS growth (\$1.25 \$2.59). Revenue growth +19.7%, earnings growth +47.3%. Serial execution on membership growth will be key focus.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Clear Secure operates biometric identity verification platforms primarily deployed at U.S. airports, enabling expedited security screening for members. The subscription-based model generates recurring revenue with 65.5% gross margins and 109.5% ROE, demonstrating exceptional unit economics as the company scales beyond airports into sports venues and healthcare.
FACTOR & THEME
Exposure to travel recovery (decelerating but stable) and biometric security adoption. Technology sector is lagging (-10.3% 20d) creating headwind. TSA PreCheck partnership expansion and venue diversification provide secular growth vectors beyond cyclical travel.
NEWS FLOW
No major announcements in last 60 days. Earnings in 7 days is the primary catalyst. Watch for membership growth metrics and venue expansion updates. 17.6% short interest with 8 days to cover creates squeeze setup on beat. Impact: High (Earnings). Technology sector weakness is headwind.
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume pattern shows accumulation attempt but not clean stair-step (vol_w3 > vol_w2). RS line positive but not at new high - relative strength fading vs market. No insider activity in 60 days. Short interest elevated (17.6%) suggesting controversy; 8 days to cover is extended.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on close below \$54.00 (base low), or on membership growth deceleration at August 5 earnings. Technology sector underperformance (-10.3% 20d) and high valuation (P/S 8.3x) create vulnerability in risk-off tape.

Fundamentals strong (47% earnings growth, 65% margins) with earnings catalyst in 7 days, but RS line not at new high and Technology sector lagging badly (-10.3%). Volume pattern is partial dry-up, not textbook. Strongest bear case: high valuation (8.3x P/S) and sector headwinds could overwhelm positive earnings. Structure building but needs sector rotation. Conviction: Medium.

YOU — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$59.97 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$15.51
% to Pivot	6.3%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	1.90 Good
52W Hi Prox	86.9%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	1944k <
Wk2	1766k <
Wk3 (oldest)	3439k
Coil Strength	43.5% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+7.9%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$4.29B
Float	86M sh
P/E (TTM)	22.8
Fwd P/E	12.9
Rev Growth	54.9%
Short %	12.8%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$18.05

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$15.51 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (3.6M+ shares)
Target: \$19.00 (measured move + analyst target cluster)
Stop: \$13.00 (base low, -10.9% from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Aug 13 - Forward P/E 12.9x vs TTM 22.8x implies 77% EPS growth (\$0.64 - \$1.13). Revenue growth exceptional at +54.9% but earnings growth -6.7% reflects investment phase. Watch for TPV growth and take-rate trends.
BUSINESS & POSITION
DLocal provides cross-border payment processing enabling global enterprises to accept payments and make payouts in emerging markets across Latin America, Africa, and Asia. The company processes for major tech platforms (Amazon, Microsoft, Spotify) and benefits from e-commerce penetration in high-growth markets with limited payment infrastructure alternatives.
FACTOR & THEME
Exposure to EM fintech adoption and e-commerce growth in Latin America - theme sentiment stabilizing after 2024-25 valuation reset. Peer read-throughs (PAGS, STNE) have shown signs of bottoming. Technology sector headwind (-10.3%) but DLO's EM exposure provides diversification.
NEWS FLOW
One insider buy of \$237K in last 60 days (non-senior, cluster score 2) - modest positive signal but not conviction-grade. Earnings in 15 days provides catalyst. Short interest 12.8% with 4.9 days to cover. Impact: Medium (Earnings). No major contract announcements recently.
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume pattern disrupted by week 3 spike (3.4M vs 1.9M/1.8M prior weeks) - suggests news-driven activity, not clean accumulation. Insider buying present (\$237K, 1 buy) but not cluster-grade. Base tight (1.9) but RS line not at new high indicates relative underperformance.

KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on close below \$13.00 (base low area), or on TPV deceleration/take-rate compression at August 13 earnings. EM currency volatility and regulatory risk in key markets (Brazil, Argentina) remain structural overhangs.

Tight base (1.9) with exceptional revenue growth (+55%), earnings catalyst in 15 days, and modest insider buying (\$237K). However, RS line not at new high, Technology sector lagging, and volume pattern disrupted by w3 spike. Strongest bear case: EM exposure creates currency/regulatory risk, and -6.7% earnings decline suggests margin pressure. Insider activity noted but cluster=2 insufficient for upgrade. Conviction: Medium.

DLO — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$15.51 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$56.94
% to Pivot	0.7%
Days in Base	14
Tightness	3.08 Fair
52W Hi Prox	87.2%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	993k <
Wk2	960k <
Wk3 (oldest)	1029k
Coil Strength	3.4% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+80.3%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$1.26B
Float	19M sh
P/E (TTM)	49.2
Fwd P/E	51.3
Rev Growth	-2.9%
Short %	41.9%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$45.00

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above \$56.94 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (1.65M+ shares)

Target: \$68.00 (prior resistance zone)

Stop: \$51.50 (base low area)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Sep 16

RS line at new high but base is loose (3.08), volume contraction minimal (3.4%), and Consumer Discretionary is lagging sector (-5.5% 20d). 41.9% short interest creates squeeze potential but fundamentals weak (declining revenue, high leverage at 247% D/E). Watch for base tightening. Conviction: Low.

CBRL — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$56.94 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Consulting Services - Economic & Litigation | Theme: Professional Services / Litigation Spend | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5.61

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$194.17
% to Pivot	2.2%
Days in Base	6
Tightness	5.61 Fair
52W Hi Prox	83.6%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	142k <
Wk2	150k <
Wk3 (oldest)	156k
Coil Strength	8.7% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+20.7%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$1.23B
Float	6M sh
P/E (TTM)	26.3
Fwd P/E	19.7
Rev Growth	10.5%
Short %	4.7%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$252.50

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above \$194.17 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (240K+ shares)

Target: \$227.00 (52-week high retest)

Stop: \$175.00 (50-day MA area)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Aug 06

Volume dry-up confirmed but base is very loose (5.61), RS line NOT at new high, and Industrials sector lagging (-3.6% 20d). Earnings in 8 days but -35.5% earnings growth deceleration is concerning. Early-stage setup needs structural improvement. Conviction: Low.

CRAI — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$194.17 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$43.24
% to Pivot	1.2%
Days in Base	12
Tightness	2.83 Fair
52W Hi Prox	85.6%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	734k <
Wk2	525k <
Wk3 (oldest)	965k
Coil Strength	23.9% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+53.9%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$1.75B
Float	40M sh
P/E (TTM)	20.7
Fwd P/E	6.9
Rev Growth	6.8%
Short %	15.0%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$53.80

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$43.24 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (975K+ shares)

Target: \$50.00 (52-week high area)
Stop: \$39.00 (50-day MA area)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Sep 28

Near pivot (1.2%) but volume pattern is non-sequential (w3 > w1), RS line not at new high, Technology sector lagging (-10.3%), and no catalyst for 61 days. Fundamentals solid (85% gross margins, 28% earnings growth) but setup lacks urgency. Monitor for sector rotation. Conviction: Low.

PRGS — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$43.24 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$46.35
% to Pivot	7.2%
Days in Base	8
Tightness	3.49 Fair
52W Hi Prox	80.6%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	86k <
Wk2	134k <
Wk3 (oldest)	188k
Coil Strength	54.1% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+27.8%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$0.57B
Float	5M sh
P/E (TTM)	-
Fwd P/E	4.6
Rev Growth	5.8%
Short %	10.2%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$42.50

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$46.35 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (195K+ shares)

Target: \$54.00 (52-week high area)
Stop: \$38.00 (recent swing low)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Aug 05

Strong volume contraction (54%) but base is loose (3.49), RS line not at new high, 7.2% to pivot is far. High leverage (324% D/E) and negative TTM earnings create fundamental concerns despite forward profitability expected. Earnings in 7 days but setup needs tightening. Conviction: Low.

ADV — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$46.35 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



MUR

Murphy Oil Corporation

\$38.69

Pivot \$40.21 | 3.9% away

RS vs SPY: -9.5%

C EARLY STAGE

\$5.55B Cap | 135M Float

Oil & Gas E&P - Gulf of Mexico Focus | Theme: Energy Capex / Offshore Production | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 7.16

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$40.21
% to Pivot	3.9%
Days in Base	10
Tightness	7.16 Fair
52W Hi Prox	89.3%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	1276k <
Wk2	1499k <
Wk3 (oldest)	1579k
Coil Strength	19.2% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	-9.5%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$5.55B
Float	135M sh
P/E (TTM)	65.6
Fwd P/E	12.5
Rev Growth	8.9%
Short %	9.6%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$43.07

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$40.21 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (2.3M+ shares)
Target: \$46.00 (measured move to prior resistance)
Stop: \$34.00 (base low, -12.1% from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Aug 05 - Forward P/E 12.5x vs TTM 65.6x reflects depressed current earnings (TTM EPS \$0.59) expected to recover to \$3.09. Revenue growth +8.9% but earnings -26.1% indicates commodity headwinds. Watch for production guidance and GoM project updates.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Murphy Oil is an independent E&P company with operations concentrated in the Gulf of Mexico, Eagle Ford Shale, and international assets. The company benefits from Energy sector leadership (+11% 20d) but individual RS is negative vs SPY, indicating underperformance vs sector peers.
FACTOR & THEME
Energy is leading sector (+11% 20d) providing strong tailwind, but MUR specifically lags with -9.5% RS vs SPY. Gulf of Mexico production exposure offers commodity leverage. Peer read-through: DVN, FANG showing strength; MUR's underperformance is company-specific.
NEWS FLOW
No significant news in last 60 days. Earnings in 7 days is primary catalyst. Energy sector strength provides macro support but company-specific RS weakness is concern. No insider activity. Impact: Medium (Earnings + sector positioning).
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume contraction confirmed (19%) but base extremely loose (7.16) disqualifies from quality VCP consideration. RS negative vs SPY despite leading sector indicates institutional preference for other E&P names. No insider activity in 60 days.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on close below \$34.00 (recent base low), or on production miss/guidance cut at August 5 earnings. Company-specific underperformance vs sector peers suggests structural issues beyond commodity exposure.
Energy sector leadership (+11%) provides tailwind but MUR individually shows negative RS (-9.5%), extremely loose base (7.16), and RS line nowhere near new high. Earnings in 7 days could be catalyst but company is underperforming sector peers. Watch for fundamental improvement. Conviction: Low.

MUR — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$40.21 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$135.96
% to Pivot	1.8%
Days in Base	11
Tightness	4.17 Fair
52W Hi Prox	85.5%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	287k <
Wk2	401k <
Wk3 (oldest)	367k
Coil Strength	22.0% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+13.8%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$4.55B
Float	33M sh
P/E (TTM)	19.4
Fwd P/E	15.0
Rev Growth	4.5%
Short %	7.1%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$156.25

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$135.96 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (460K+ shares)

Target: \$156.00 (52-week high)
Stop: \$122.00 (50-day MA area)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
Aug 06

Near pivot (1.8%) with earnings in 8 days and defensive sector tailwind (Consumer Staples +4.9%), but base is loose (4.17), RS line not at new high, and volume pattern only partial contraction. Solid fundamentals (PEG 0.88, 57% gross margin) but setup quality insufficient for higher grade. Conviction: Low.

CVSA — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$135.96 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Personal Services - Tax Preparation | Theme: Consumer Services / Defensive Cyclical | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 6.2

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$47.33
% to Pivot	0.3%
Days in Base	2
Tightness	6.20 Fair
52W Hi Prox	84.3%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	1725k <
Wk2	1715k <
Wk3 (oldest)	1974k
Coil Strength	12.6% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+49.0%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$5.98B
Float	126M sh
P/E (TTM)	8.4
Fwd P/E	8.1
Rev Growth	5.3%
Short %	22.5%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$42.00

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above \$47.33 on volume >120% of 20-day avg (2.85M+ shares)

Target: \$56.00 (52-week high)

Stop: \$43.00 (base low area, -8.9% from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Aug 11 - Trailing P/E 8.4x, Forward P/E 8.1x - deep value metrics. Revenue growth +5.3%, earnings growth +24.2%. This will be fiscal Q1 (off-season), so expectations are low. Dividend yield and buyback capacity are focus areas.

BUSINESS & POSITION

H&R Block is the largest retail tax preparation company in the U.S., providing assisted and DIY tax services through ~10,000 retail locations and digital platforms. The highly seasonal business generates substantial cash flow with 43% operating margins, though structural threats from free filing and AI tax tools loom.

FACTOR & THEME

Defensive consumer services exposure with counter-cyclical elements (tax filing is non-discretionary). Consumer Cyclical sector lagging (-5.5%) but HRB's defensive characteristics may provide insulation. AI disruption theme is headwind long-term but near-term cash flows stable.

NEWS FLOW

22.5% short interest with 8.6 days to cover creates meaningful squeeze potential. Earnings in 13 days. No major announcements in 60 days. Consumer Cyclical sector weakness is headwind. Impact: Medium (Earnings + short squeeze potential).

INSTITUTIONAL

Very near pivot (0.3%) but base just formed (2 days, extremely loose at 6.2) and volume pattern shows minimal contraction. High short interest (22.5%) indicates significant skepticism. No insider activity in 60 days. RS line positive but not at new high.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below \$43.00 (recent swing low), or on subscriber losses/guidance cut at August 11 earnings. AI disruption narrative (TurboTax, free filing expansion) is structural bear case that could accelerate.

Extremely close to pivot (0.3%) with short squeeze potential (22.5% SI, 8.6 DTC) and earnings in 13 days, but base is brand new (2 days) and very loose (6.2), RS line not at new high, sector lagging. Needs consolidation time to form proper VCP structure. Conviction: Low.

HRB — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$47.33 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Oil & Gas E&P - Williston Basin | Theme: Energy Capex / Shale Production | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 7.24

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$141.84
% to Pivot	3.9%
Days in Base	9
Tightness	7.24 Fair
52W Hi Prox	89.8%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	698k <
Wk2	806k <
Wk3 (oldest)	799k
Coil Strength	12.7% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	-8.6%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$7.68B
Float	53M sh
P/E (TTM)	-
Fwd P/E	9.3
Rev Growth	38.5%
Short %	7.6%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$165.67

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above \$141.84 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (1.04M+ shares)

Target: \$152.00 (52-week high)

Stop: \$125.00 (base low area)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Aug 05

Energy sector leading (+11%) but CHRD individually shows negative RS (-8.6%), extremely loose base (7.24), and RS line not at new high - similar profile to MUR. Earnings in 7 days but company underperforming sector peers. Base needs significant tightening. Conviction: Low.

CHRD — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$141.84 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)

